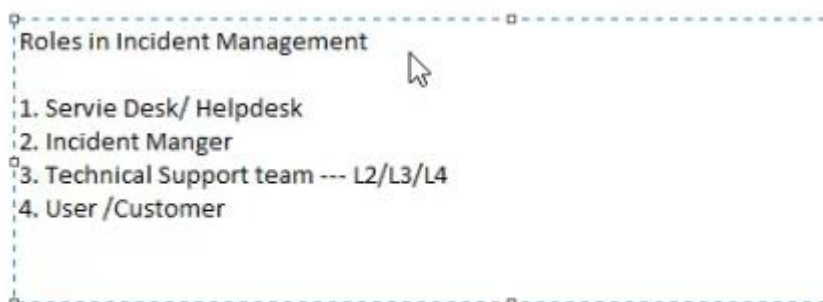


Roles in incident management and SLA – 86

Introduction

Incident Management is one of the core processes in IT Service Management (ITSM). Its goal is to restore normal service operations as quickly as possible and minimize business impact. For effective incident handling, multiple roles are defined with clear responsibilities. Along with roles, Service Level Agreements (SLAs) define the expectations and commitments for response and resolution times of incidents.



Roles in Incident Management

1. Service Desk / Helpdesk

- Acts as the single point of contact for users.
- Responsible for receiving incident reports via phone, email, ticketing tools, or chat.
- Creates incident tickets with accurate details such as user information, time, category, and description.
- Performs first-level troubleshooting like password resets, basic configuration issues, or connectivity checks.
- Communicates with users about ticket status and progress.
- Escalates unresolved incidents to higher technical support teams.

2. Incident Manager

- Oversees the entire incident management process.
- Ensures incidents are properly logged, categorized, prioritized, and assigned.

- Coordinates communication between teams during major incidents.
- Responsible for meeting SLA targets and reporting incident statistics to management.
- Conducts post-incident reviews to identify root causes and prevent recurrence.
- Ensures documentation and knowledge base updates after resolution.

3. Technical Support Teams (L2, L3, L4)

- **L2 Support:** Handles issues that the service desk cannot resolve. Focuses on application errors, OS-level problems, and network issues.
- **L3 Support:** Deals with complex problems that require deeper technical expertise, often involving developers, system architects, or infrastructure specialists.
- **L4 Support:** Provided by external vendors or third-party providers when incidents are related to vendor-specific hardware, software, or cloud services.
- Each level ensures effective troubleshooting, resolution, and escalation if required.
- They also provide fixes, patches, and permanent solutions.

4. User / Customer

- Reports issues to the service desk accurately and promptly.
- Provides necessary details such as screenshots, error logs, or steps to reproduce the problem.
- Cooperates with IT teams during troubleshooting.
- Confirms resolution and closes the incident when satisfied.
- Gives feedback that helps improve the process.

SLA ---- Service Level Agreement

P1 -- Immediate

P2 -- High

P3 -- Medium

P4 -- Low

Response Time for P1,p2,p3,p4 will be 5 Min

Resolution Time --- P1 --- Depends upon the time

P2 --- Specific Time Period

p3 --- 4 Hours

p4 -- 8 hours or More

Service Level Agreement (SLA) in Incident Management

An SLA defines the expected service levels between the IT provider and the business. It ensures accountability and sets clear timelines for response and resolution.

Incident Priorities and SLA Commitments

- **P1 – Immediate**
 - Critical incidents that impact the entire business or core operations.
 - Response Time: 5 minutes.
 - Resolution Time: Depends on the issue complexity, but requires 24x7 attention until resolved.
- **P2 – High**
 - Major incidents affecting multiple users or critical systems but with workarounds available.
 - Response Time: 5 minutes.
 - Resolution Time: Within a specific agreed timeframe (example: 2 hours or by end of business day).
- **P3 – Medium**
 - Moderate incidents affecting individual users or small groups without high business impact.
 - Response Time: 5 minutes.
 - Resolution Time: 4 hours.

- **P4 – Low**

- Minor incidents with minimal business impact, often related to small bugs or cosmetic issues.
- Response Time: 5 minutes.
- Resolution Time: 8 hours or more, depending on workload and scheduling.

Importance of Roles and SLA

- **Clear Accountability:** Defined roles ensure no incident is left unattended.
- **Structured Escalation:** Escalation levels ensure the right expertise is applied at the right time.
- **Faster Resolution:** SLA-driven timelines push teams to restore services quickly.
- **User Satisfaction:** Transparency and timely updates build trust with users.
- **Continuous Improvement:** Post-incident reviews highlight recurring issues and preventive measures.

Example Scenario

- A banking application goes down for all users. This is classified as **P1**.
- Service desk receives calls and logs tickets immediately.
- Incident manager declares a major incident and coordinates L2 and L3 teams.
- L3 team identifies a database crash, restores backup, and brings services online.
- SLA ensures that response was immediate, and resolution was given high priority.
- Incident manager documents the case and reviews the database maintenance process to prevent recurrence.

Incident Management relies on collaboration between multiple roles, each with specific responsibilities. SLAs provide a measurable framework to ensure timely response and resolution. Together, they form the backbone of IT service stability, business continuity, and user satisfaction.